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Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia

Description

Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia is one of many types of anemia, which is a group of conditions characterized by a shortage of healthy red blood cells. This shortage prevents the blood from carrying an adequate supply of oxygen to the body's tissues.

Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia results from an inadequate amount (deficiency) of iron in the bloodstream. It is described as "iron-refractory" because the condition is totally resistant (refractory) to treatment with iron given orally and partially resistant to iron given in other ways, such as intravenously (by IV). In people with this form of anemia, red blood cells are abnormally small (microcytic) and pale (hypochromic). The symptoms of iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia can include tiredness (fatigue), weakness, pale skin, and other complications. These symptoms are most pronounced during childhood, although they tend to be mild. Affected individuals usually have normal growth and development.

Frequency

Although iron deficiency anemia is relatively common, the prevalence of the iron-refractory form of the disease is unknown. At least 50 cases have been described in the medical literature. Researchers suspect that iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia is underdiagnosed because affected individuals with very mild symptoms may never come to medical attention.

Causes

Mutations in the *TMPRSS6* [<https://medlineplus.gov/genetics/gene/tmprss6/>] gene cause iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia. This gene provides instructions for making a protein called matriptase-2, which helps regulate iron levels in the body. *TMPRSS6* gene mutations reduce or eliminate functional matriptase-2, which

disrupts iron regulation and leads to a shortage of iron in the bloodstream. Iron is an essential component of hemoglobin, which is the molecule in red blood cells that carries oxygen. When not enough iron is available in the bloodstream, less hemoglobin is produced, causing red blood cells to be abnormally small and pale. The abnormal cells cannot carry oxygen effectively to the body's cells and tissues, which leads to fatigue, weakness, and other symptoms of anemia.

Learn more about the gene associated with Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia

TMPRSS6 [<https://medlineplus.gov/genetics/gene/tmprss6/>]

Inheritance

This condition is inherited in an autosomal recessive pattern, which means both copies of the gene in each cell have mutations. The parents of an individual with an autosomal recessive condition each carry one copy of the mutated gene, but they typically do not show signs and symptoms of the condition.

Other Names for This Condition

- Anemia, hypochromic microcytic, with defect in iron metabolism
- IRIDA
- IRIDA syndrome
- Iron-handling disorder, hereditary

Additional Information & Resources

Genetic Testing Information

- Genetic Testing Registry: Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia [<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/gtr/conditions/C0085576/>] 

Genetic and Rare Diseases Information Center

- IRIDA syndrome [<https://rarediseases.info.nih.gov/diseases/10957/index>] 

Patient Support and Advocacy Resources

- National Organization for Rare Disorders (NORD) [<https://rarediseases.org/>]

Clinical Trials

- ClinicalTrials.gov [<https://clinicaltrials.gov/search?cond=%22Iron-refractory iron deficiency anemia%22>] 

Catalog of Genes and Diseases from OMIM

- IRON-REFRACTORY IRON DEFICIENCY ANEMIA; IRIDA [<https://omim.org/entry/206200>]

Scientific Articles on PubMed

- PubMed [<https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/?term=%28%28iron-refractory+iron+deficiency+anemia%5BTIAB%5D%29+OR+%28irida%5BTIAB%5D%29+OR+%28pseudo-iron-deficiency+anemia%5BTIAB%5D%29%29+AND+english%5Bla%5D+AND+human%5Bmh%5D+AND+%22last+3600+days%22%5Bdp%5D>] 

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Hypochromia [<https://medlineplus.gov/ency/article/003455.htm>]

Iron deficiency anemia [<https://medlineplus.gov/ency/article/000584.htm>]

Related Medical Tests

Iron Tests [<https://medlineplus.gov/lab-tests/iron-tests/>]

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